

MY ENGLISH BOOK

Class - VI



DIRECTORATE OF TEACHER EDUCATION AND
STATE COUNCIL OF EDUCATIONAL RESEARCH & TRAINING,
ODISHA, BHUBANESWAR

ODISHA SCHOOL EDUCATION PROGRAMME AUTHORITY,
BHUBANESWAR

MY ENGLISH BOOK

Class - VI

(Experimental Edition)

Editors :

Dr. Manmatha Kundu (Chief Editor)
Dr. Dharendra Kumar Mohanty
Sri Pranakrishna Mohanty
Sri Pratap Kumar Samantasinghar
Sri Lalindra Amat
Sri Gadadhar Behura

Reviewers :

Prof. (Dr) Debendra Kumar Ray
Dr. Umesh Prasad Patnaik
Sri Sashibhusan Hota
Sri Bijay Kumar Mohanty
Sri Prasant Kumar Patnaik
Sri Gopal Chandra Tripathy
Sri Abhaya Kumar Muduli

Guidance :

Sri Indramani Tripathy,
Director, ELTI, Odisha, Bhubaneswar

Coordinator :

Dr. Tilottama Senapati, Dr. Sabita Sahoo

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PREFACE

The Govt. of Odisha has decided to strengthen the teaching/learning of English in Odia medium Govt. Schools. The English Language Teaching Institute (ELTI) has already prepared a handbook on teaching English at the primary level. About sixty thousand teachers have been trained with the help of the book, during 2016-2017 and each teacher has been provided with a copy of the book. Next, the ELTI with the help of SCERT and OPEPA has prepared this new series of textbooks in English from Class-III to Class- VIII based on sound principles of English Language Teaching and principles of pedagogy enshrined in NCF 2005. The books have been tried out with real learners and teachers. Necessary corrections have been made accordingly. I wish the teachers to read the introduction and notes for them provided in the books and teach the books accordingly. I also want the Inspecting Officials to go through the textbooks and supervise classes accordingly. The workbooks are carefully built into the textbooks. The teachers should use the books following a learner-centered approach and make learners do the tasks. They should correct learners' scripts and provide feedback. The Inspecting Officials are expected to supervise this regularly. Each textbook has also in-built tests to test the performance of both the learners and teachers. Language indicators for each class are also provided at the end of the book for the guidance of both the teachers and Inspecting Officials. This will help the parents to check the progress of their wards. Attempts are also being made to prepare similar text books in other subjects from the coming years based on these sound principles. But unfortunately, our attempts to strengthen teaching/learning through good textbooks failed to yield expected results due to wide spread prevalent of cheap bazaar notes (Meaning Book) prepared only with the motives of commercial gains. These books provide cheap ready-made helps by working out the tasks/activities thereby preventing students from getting/developing skills and restrict them from the pleasure of doing the workbook tasks/activities on their own.

I am sure the new series will help our learners excel in all the four language skills of English --- Listening, Speaking, Reading and Writing. I thank the Editors and the Reviewers for their sincere efforts in preparing the excellent materials. I also thank Dr. Manmatha Kundu, the Academic Adviser and Mr. Indramani Tripathy, the Director of ELTI under whose academic and administrative guidance the books were prepared.

Any suggestions for the improvement of the book are welcome.

Commissioner-cum-Secretary
Department of School and Mass Education,
Govt. of Odisha

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INTRODUCTION

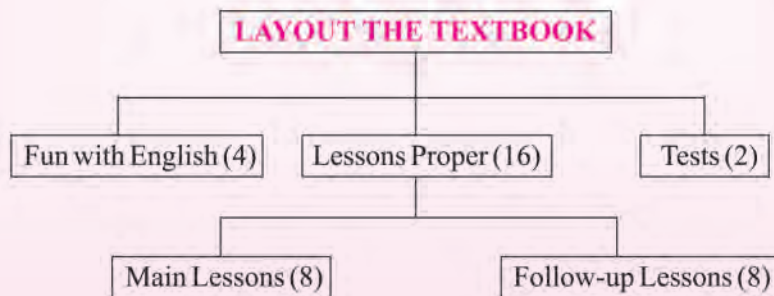
The Secret of Language Learning

Language is mostly learnt through exposure and use in meaningful contexts. While the exposure to language is mainly done through listening and reading, use is done through speaking and writing. The more one listens to a language and reads in a language, the more s/he gets exposed to the language. Exposure lays the foundation of a language and also the foundation for using the language. One cannot use (speak) the language unless one has sufficiently listened to the language. One cannot write in the language unless one has widely read in the language. And both the exposure and use are to be done in the meaningful contexts. What one listens and reads should be useful and interesting to him/her. Similarly, what one speaks and writes should also be interesting and useful for the user. In other words, all these are to be done in contexts and the user should be involved in activities. This is the secret behind learning any language.

What implication does this have for teaching English to our learners ? First, our learners should be sufficiently exposed to English through listening. In case of acquiring mother tongue, a child listens to the language for long to be able to speak. Listening to the language lays foundation for speaking. Do we provide enough exposure to English through listening before teaching our learners to speak and write in our Odia medium schools? Certainly not. We usually tend to start teaching of English from reading and writing. This is why our learners in our Odia medium schools face difficulties in learning English. Then how to overcome such difficulties ? In Order to do this we have to change the current trend of teaching English. Instead of beginning teaching of reading and writing, we should first develop the listening and speaking skills of our learners through storytelling and TPR (Total Physical Response) activities.

The Textbook

The class VI English textbook has also been revised and rewritten keeping in mind the development of listening and speaking skills of our learners along with the skills of reading and writing. In this book, there are enough listening and speaking activities provided under each lesson mainly through listening and speaking activities. The layout of the book is as follows .



The four “Fun with English” lessons are simple and interesting. There are one poem, and three stories with very interesting mind-engaging activities. Hence, the name. The main purpose of this section is helping learners learn what they have not learned before- remediation not re-teaching but teaching in an interesting and enjoyable way. Currently, the skill of most learners is below their class level, more so in English classes. If their skills are not levelled up through right kind of materials, the main lessons will not work and the teacher will take recourse to reading aloud, explaining the text often in Odia and somehow complete the course as they were accustomed to do before. The tasks provided,

therefore , are based on development of language skills. These three “Fun with English” lessons serve as steps for reaching the lessons proper.

Lessons Proper

There are eight lessons – four prose pieces and four poems. These pieces are very carefully chosen, the main criteria of selection being simplicity (language) and interest value for the young learners of 10-11 years old. Each lesson has three major sections: Pre-reading, While-reading and Post-reading. The purpose of pre-reading is motivating the learners to read the text. The while-reading phase is devoted to interactive reading. The learner is taught to interact (communicate) with the writer through the text. This is the most important phase of the lesson. If this part is not properly done, the next phase, post-reading becomes futile. But in the current practice, instead of helping learners to interact (communicate) with the writer; the teacher reads aloud the text himself/herself and explains the text mostly in Odia. The post-reading phase is devoted to interesting learning activities based on the text. While doing these activities, the learner reads and rereads the text again and again on his/her own without being conscious of the fact that s/he is reading so many times. The activities become the main product and learning skills come as by-product.

FOLLOW-UP LESSONS

These are, in fact, sub-lessons of the main lessons. There is mainly one sub-lesson under each main lesson. The sub-lessons are shorter and simpler than the main lesson. The themes are related to the themes of the main lessons. Compared to the main lessons, the sub-lessons are less controlled in the sense that both the teacher and learners are given freedom to work on their own, the primary purpose being development of autonomous learning. While the questions and activities are provided in the main lessons by the editors, teachers are encouraged to frame their own questions and activities for sub-lessons. Similarly, the learners are encouraged to read and comprehend the text and do the activities on their own with less guidance from the teachers. Learners are encouraged to self-correct and peer-correct their own writings. The other purpose of these sub-lessons is to relate the main texts to their daily life experiences and real life use of English. In other words, they are discouraged to be textbook centric. Earlier, all these sub-texts were called ‘tail-pieces’ to be read and enjoyed by the learners without any tasks or activities. In addition to the sub-lessons, we also provide tail-pieces to some lessons.

Tests

There are two tests, one after the 3rd lesson and the other at the end. The tests are of 100 marks each. The tests intend to test the English language skills of the learners, the skills expected to be developed through these lessons. The test results will provide feedback to both the learners and the teachers- the learners will get the feedback whether they have developed the English language skills studying the text or not and the teacher will get the feedback whether they have been successful in helping the learners develop the expected English language skills or not. The tests will also help teachers frame similar small tests to be administered to students on a regular basis (formative tests).

Interlinking Materials and Methods

During the early phase of textbook writing, materials had hardly any link with methods. The textbook writers’ job was to prepare materials and the teacher’s job was to decide methods to handle the materials in the classroom. This delinking of materials from method made teaching learning ineffective. Later, attempts were, therefore, made to link material and method. The material writers while preparing textbook, visualized the method the teacher is to use to transact the material in the classroom. In fact , now it is realized that method is more important than materials shown through the

mathematical calculations: Good Materials + Bad Method= No result , Bad Materials+ Good Method= Some results. As a result, only persons having firsthand experience of teaching are asked to prepare material and trying out of material with real learners is made obligatory. Teachers use their own ways of handling the material, the method that is easy and convenient to them and the universally accepted and used method is reading aloud followed by explanation / summarization of the text. But in the book. We have linked the materials with the methods .The general approach suggested is learner-centred and activity –oriented approach with some specific methods of teaching such as BS (Brainstorming), Chain-drill, VMDT (Visual Memory Development Technique) and MT (Mental Talk).A brief description of these four techniques is provided in Appendix-II; Notes on Techniques .

The book is based on the good principles of education stated in NCF-2005 adapted to our context. The method and approach used are mostly teacher-centred. The book takes into account this fact and makes provision for improving the skills of both the learners and teachers and the state of teaching learning , especially English. The book, in other words , provides a comprehensive treatment for the major faults of the teaching /learning in general and the teaching / learning of English in particular.

ପ୍ରିୟ ଛାତ୍ରଛାତ୍ରୀ

ତୁମ୍ଭେମାନେ ସହଜରେ କିପରି ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବ, ସେଥିପାଇଁ ଏ ବହିଟି ପ୍ରସ୍ତୁତ କରାଯାଇଛି । ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା ସମ୍ବନ୍ଧରେ ତୁମ୍ଭମାନଙ୍କୁ ଆମେ କିଛି କହିବାକୁ ଚାହୁଁ । ତୁମେ ସବୁ ଶୁଣିବତ ?

ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା କ’ଣ ପାଇଁ ଦରକାର ? ଏ ବିଷୟରେ ନିଶ୍ଚୟ ତୁମ୍ଭମାନଙ୍କର କିଛି ଧାରଣା ଅଛି । କଥା ହେଲା ତୃତୀୟ ଶ୍ରେଣୀଠାରୁ କଲେଜ ପାଠ ଶେଷ ହେବା ପର୍ଯ୍ୟନ୍ତ ଇଂରାଜୀ ତୁମ୍ଭମାନଙ୍କପାଇଁ ଏକ ବାଧ୍ୟତାମୂଳକ ବିଷୟ । ଏହା ବ୍ୟତୀତ ତୁମ୍ଭେମାନେ ଯଦି ମେଟ୍ରିକ୍ ପାଠ ପରେ ପୁଣ୍ୟ ଠାରୁ ବିଜ୍ଞାନ ପଢ଼ିବା ପାଇଁ ଚାହଁବ, ସେ ପାଠସବୁ ତୁମ୍ଭମାନଙ୍କୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଭାଷା ମାଧ୍ୟମରେ ପଢ଼ିବାପାଇଁ ପଢ଼ିବ ଏବଂ ତାପରେ ଯଦି ମେଡ଼ିକାଲ ବା ଇଞ୍ଜିନିୟରିଂ ପଢ଼ିବ, ସେସବୁ ପାଠ ତୁମ୍ଭମାନଙ୍କୁ ଇଂରାଜୀରେ ହିଁ ପଢ଼ିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ । ଆମ ରାଜ୍ୟ ବାହାରକୁ ଗଲେ ତୁମ୍ଭମାନଙ୍କୁ ଇଂରାଜୀରେ କଥାବାର୍ତ୍ତା କରିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ । ବଡ଼ ହୋଇ ଚାକିରୀ କଲେ ଚାକିରୀର କାମପାଇଁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ନିହାତି ଜାଣିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ । ଆଉ ଯଦି ଚାକିରୀ ପାଇଁ ଦେଶ ବାହାରକୁ ଯିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ, ଇଂରାଜୀ ନହେଲେ ନ ଚଳେ ।

ତେଣୁ ପ୍ରଶ୍ନ ଉଠେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା କେମିତି ? ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା ବିଷୟରେ ଆମ୍ଭମାନଙ୍କର କିଛି ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ଅଛି । ଆମ ସେସବୁ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣାକୁ ଦୂର କରିବାକୁ ପଡ଼ିବ । ପ୍ରଥମ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ହେଲା, ଇଂରାଜୀ ଗୋଟିଏ କଷ୍ଟ ବିଷୟ । ସତରେ ତାହା ନୁହଁ । ଅନେକ ଦିଗରୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଭାଷା ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଠାରୁ ସହଜ । ପ୍ରଥମ କଥା ହେଲା, ଇଂରାଜୀ ଅକ୍ଷର ଲେଖା ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଅକ୍ଷର ଲେଖା ଠାରୁ ସହଜ । ଯିଏ ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଲେଖା ଶିଖି ସାରିଛି ଇଂରାଜୀ ଲେଖା ତା ପାଇଁ କିଛି ନୁହଁ । ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଲେଖାରେ କଷ୍ଟ ହେଲା ଯୁକ୍ତାକ୍ଷର । ଇଂରାଜୀରେ ଯୁକ୍ତାକ୍ଷର ନାହିଁ କହିଲେ ଚଳେ । ଆମର ଆଉ ଗୋଟିଏ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ହେଲା ଗୋଟିଏ ଭାଷା ଅନ୍ୟ ଭାଷାଠାରୁ ବେଶ୍ ଅଲଗା । ଏଇ ଯେମିତି ଆମେ ଭାବୁ ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଠାରୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ବେଶ୍ ଅଲଗା । ସତରେ ତାହା ନୁହଁ । ସବୁ ଭାଷାମାନଙ୍କ ମଧ୍ୟରେ ପାଖାପାଖି ଅଣା ପ୍ରତିଶତ ସାମଞ୍ଜସ୍ୟ ରହିଛି । ଏହାର ଅର୍ଥ ହେଲା ଗୋଟିଏ ଭାଷା ଜାଣିଥିବା ଲୋକପାଇଁ ଅନ୍ୟ ଭାଷା ଶିଖିବା ସହଜ । ଯଦି ଜଣେ ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଭାଷା ଶିଖିଛି, ତା ପାଇଁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ବା ଯେକୌଣସି ଭାଷା ଶିଖିବା ସହଜ ।

ଆତ୍ମମାନଙ୍କର ଆଉ ଗୋଟିଏ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ହେଲା, ସ୍କୁଲକୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବାପାଇଁ ଆସିବା ପୂର୍ବରୁ ଆମେ କିଛି ଇଂରାଜୀ ଜାଣି ନାହୁଁ । ଇଂରାଜୀ ଆତ୍ମମାନଙ୍କ ପାଇଁ ପୁରାପୁରି ଗୋଟିଏ ନୂଆ ବିଷୟ । ଏ ଧାରଣା କିନ୍ତୁ ଠିକ୍ ନୁହେଁ । ଆମ ବାତାବରଣରୁ ତୁମେ ସବୁ କେତେ ଜଣ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଶିଖି ସାରିଛ । ଏଇ ଦେଖିବା କେବଳ ସାଇକେଲ୍ ସମ୍ବନ୍ଧରେ ତୁମେମାନେ କେତେ ଜଣ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଜାଣିଛ । ସାଇକେଲ୍‌ର ସବୁ ପାର୍ଟସ୍‌ର ନାମ କହିଲ । ବହୁ ପାର୍ଟସ୍‌ର ଓଡ଼ିଆ ଆମେ ଜାଣିନୁ । ଏଇ ଯେମିତି ହାଣ୍ଡେଲ୍, ବ୍ରେକ୍, ଟ୍ୟୁବ୍, ଟାୟାର ଇତ୍ୟାଦି । ସେମିତି ତମେ ଯାନବାହାନ, ଖାଦ୍ୟପେୟ, ଡ୍ରେସ୍, ଖେଳ, ଡାକ୍ତରଖାନା, ସିନେମା, ଟିଭି, ଟ୍ରେନ୍ ଆଦି ବିଷୟରେ କେତେ ଜଣ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଶିଖିଛ । କେବଳ ମୋବାଇଲ୍ ପାଇଁ କେତେ ଜଣ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଅଛି, ଦେଖିଲ । ସ୍କୁଲରେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା ପୂର୍ବରୁ ଚୀନ, ଗୁଗୁଆ ଭଳି ଦେଶମାନଙ୍କର ଛାତ୍ରଛାତ୍ରୀ କମ୍ ସଂଖ୍ୟକ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଜାଣିଥିଲା ବେଳେ ତୁମେମାନେ ପାଖାପାଖି ହଜାରେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶବ୍ଦ ଶିଖିସାରିଛ ତେଣୁ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବା କାହାପାଇଁ ସହଜ – ତୁମମାନଙ୍କ ପାଇଁ ନା ସେମାନଙ୍କ ପାଇଁ ?

ଆତ୍ମମାନଙ୍କର ଗୋଟିଏ ଭୁଲ୍ ଧାରଣା ହେଲେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ମିଡ଼ିୟମ୍ ସ୍କୁଲରେ ପାଠ ପଢ଼ିଲେ ବା ଇଂରାଜୀ ପ୍ରଥମ ଶ୍ରେଣୀରୁ ପଢ଼ିଲେ, ଆମର ଇଂରାଜୀ ଭଲ ହେବ, ତାହା ଠିକ୍ ନୁହେଁ । ବରଂ ପ୍ରଥମରୁ ମାତୃଭାଷାରେ ବେଶ କିଛି ବର୍ଷ ଭଲ ପାଠ ପଢ଼ି ପରେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ପଢ଼ିଲେ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଭାଷା ଜ୍ଞାନ ଭଲ ହୁଏ । ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିଖିବାଟା କେତେ ଚଳକ୍ଲସରୁ ଶିଖିଲେ, ତା ଉପରେ ନିର୍ଭର କରେ ନାହିଁ । ନିର୍ଭର କରେ ଇଂରାଜୀ କେମିତି ପଢ଼ାଯାଉଛି, ତା ପାଠ୍ୟପୁସ୍ତକ, ପାଠ ପଢ଼ି ଓ ଶିକ୍ଷକଙ୍କର ଦକ୍ଷତା ଉପରେ । ଏହା ବ୍ୟତିତ ତୁମର ନିଷ୍ଠା ଓ ଆଗ୍ରହ ତୁମ ଇଂରାଜୀ ଶିକ୍ଷଣ ପ୍ରକ୍ରିୟାକୁ ସହଜ କରାଇବ ।

Abbreviations used in the book :

adj	:	Adjective
BS	:	Brain Storming
MCQ	:	Multiple Choice Question
MT	:	Mental Talk
phr	:	Phrase
n	:	Noun
SGP	:	Sense Group Paragraph
v	:	Verb
VMDT	:	Visual Memory Development Technique